



My Internship!



Introduction

Emmy Schulz



My SMART Goals

Recap

- People Management
- Professional
- Company
- Culture

How have these goals helped me grow?

“See a need, fill a need.”

Project Highlights

State Infographic Redesign

Research, Pitching, and Designing

“The Dairy Difference”

Goal: To show how Dairy is delivering nutrition, sustainability, and economic impact.

Answering the question of “What does dairy do for me and the planet?”

- Research: Focused on Cow Vs. Product, Byproduct & Cow Diet stats, Industry water use, sustainability, and economic impact.
- Pitch: Presented ideas and received helpful feedback.
- Redesigning: Created a new look for the graphic that shows a story.

Old vs. New!

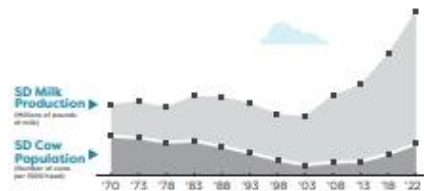
South Dakota Dairy Farms, Then & Now:

Innovation, Conservation & Dedication



From the **1970s... to today,**

dairy farmers have become more sustainable, with advances in cow care, nutrition, genetics and technology. Milk production in the U.S. has nearly doubled despite fewer cows.¹



Made in communities across the country, dairy foods contribute 3% of the U.S. gross domestic product.⁶



94% of dairy farms are family owned and operated.⁷

Dairy totaled \$4.85 billion
in economic impact (direct and indirect) in SD, 2021.⁸

Dairy led to 14,700 jobs
(direct and indirect) in SD, 2021.⁸

As part of a stewardship pledge to consumers, the dairy industry is pursuing a voluntary goal to achieve greenhouse gas neutrality by 2050.²

80% of dairy cows' diets comes from plant fibers and feedstuffs that they can digest but humans can't, and would otherwise go to landfills.³

The U.S. dairy industry has **decreased its water use by 65+%** over the past decades.⁴

Most dairy farm manure is incorporated into fields as natural fertilizer, **increasing soil's water-holding capacity by 20%⁵**



The Dairy Difference: South Dakota's Impact

South Dakota's Dairy industry is delivering nutrition, sustainability, and economic impact.



Cows eat an estimated **26.5 POUNDS OF BYPRODUCT EVERY DAY.**
This includes cottonseed, distillers' grains, and more - all things humans can't eat!



Dairy is packed with **VITAMIN A, VITAMIN D, CALCIUM, PROTEIN, AND MORE!**
In fact, one serving of milk contains 13 ESSENTIAL vitamins and minerals your body needs!



From 2007-2020, it took **13% LESS GREENHOUSE GASES TO PRODUCE A GALLON OF MILK.**
Thanks to improved genetics, farming, and technology advancements, and cow care practices, creating a more sustainable industry.



Dairy farms transform manure into **RENEWABLE ENERGY & NATURAL FERTILIZER.**
This powers communities and nourishes crops, creating a sustainable cycle for people and the planet!



Did You Know...

Water is recycled up to **FOUR times** on dairy farms!



From Farm & Family To Economy

94% OF DAIRY FARMS are family owned and operated

In South Dakota, dairy totaled **1.5 BILLION** in total economic impact in 2025.

Farmer Profile

“A Barn of Mothers with Amanda Zigan.”

- In the heart of Long Prairie, Minnesota, there's a barn filled with mothers, one in particular who keeps it all running. Amanda isn't just the owner, herdsman, bookkeeper, technician; she's also a devoted mother, not just to her four children but to every cow in the barn.
- Visited Amanda and toured the farm, she's a part of the DEAL program and is a great person to represent Midwest Dairy.



Dairy Star

“What’s one thing most people get completely wrong about agriculture—and what’s the real dairy story?”

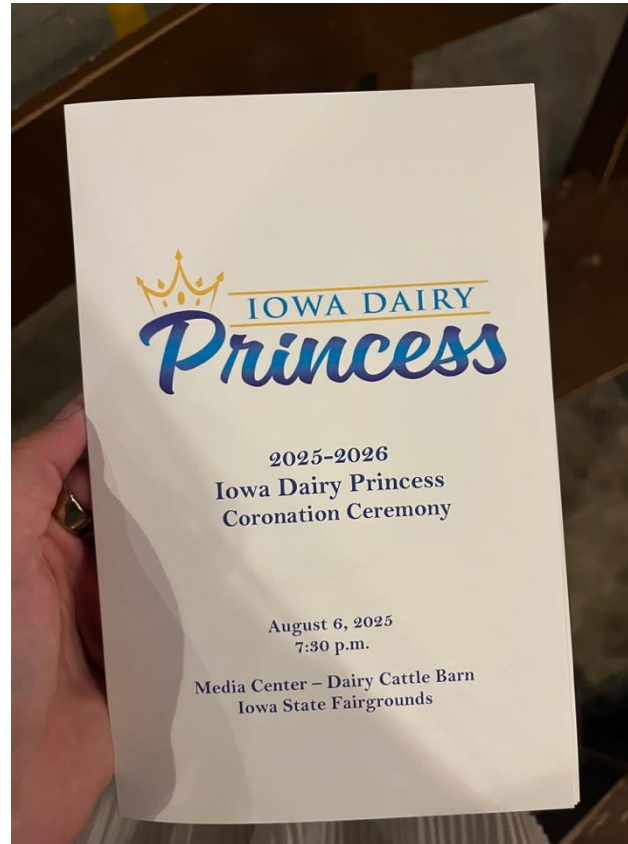
- “Agriculture is the most healthful, most useful, and most noble employment of man.”
- George Washington
- In the article, I write about the misconception or misunderstanding that working in agriculture, on a farm, is not just a job. It’s a lifestyle and a purpose.
- “Farmers don’t punch in, and there's no ‘leaving work at work’ when your ‘office’ is the view outside your kitchen window.”

Event Highlights

The Iowa State Fair

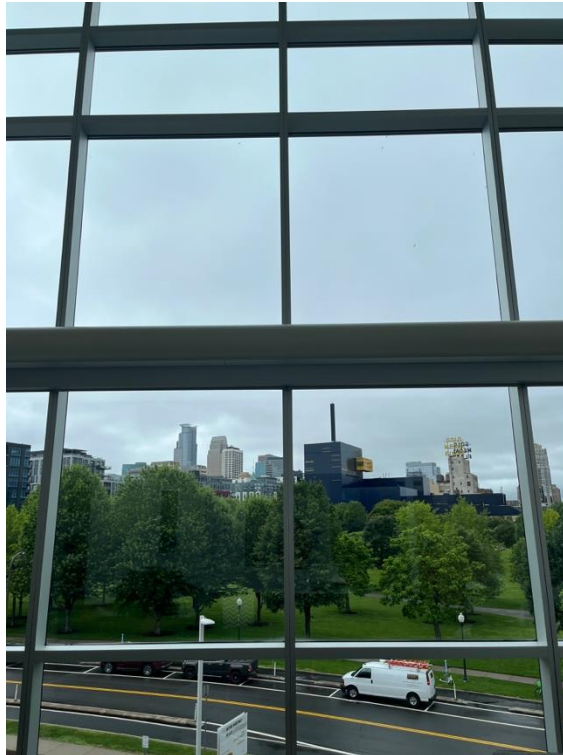
Princess Coronation, Promotions, Farmer goes to the fair, Facebook Live!

- Such an amazing experience!! (Minnesota is better.....!)



Division Board Meeting

- Presented and introduced myself to the board!
- Met farmers and heard their stories.
- Listened and learned!



How does my internship
support my future goals?

Midwest Dairy Opportunity

Midwest Dairy Opportunity

Partnerships with Non-food brands such as fitness and wellness apps: Consumer idea!

- Position Midwest Dairy as a relevant and trusted source of nutrition for active lifestyles, extending dairy's role beyond mealtime and into wellness routines.
- Target audience
- Partnership plan:

Apps such as Strava (runners/cyclists), Fitbod (strength training), TeamBuildr (Strength and conditioning platform for college athletes).

Sponsored recovery tips or “post-workout fuel” reminders.

Athlete storytelling, wellness tie-ins, and information all linked to Midwest Dairy and usdairy.com

Midwest Dairy Opportunity

Dairy Innovation Week media campaign: Farmer opportunity!

Focused on highlighting innovation, sustainability, technology, and the amazing things farmers and dairy are doing!

Targeting mainly farmers who invest in checkoff, this would showcase farmer-led technology and research Midwest Dairy invests in, along with new products like protein-forward drinks or products featured in the VentureFuel contest.

“The future of dairy”

Branded series: “Did you know Midwest Dairy is behind this?”

Promoting influencers “Wellness Warriors”

Questions?



Thank You!

